



The Hypocrisy of the Gurus

*There was a time when a fool and his money were soon parted,
but now it happens to everybody.*

~ ADLAI STEVENSON

YOU'VE BEEN DUPED

Suppose after college you're getting a bit pudgy around the middle and decide it's time to get back in shape. You enroll in a community college class called "Healthy Nutrition: Eat Your Way to a Beautiful Body."

On the first day of class, you arrive early, seat yourself, and anxiously await the class instructor. After a few minutes, an obese man walks into the room and waddles to the front of the class. You think, "Wow, he's fat . . . but he's here to change that . . . good for him!" As the man profusely sweats while fumbling with a stack of papers, you glance at the student chair near the man and wonder if he can fit on it . . . he's twice the size of the chair!

Then suddenly you're hit with the paradox. This isn't a student but the instructor! Are you freaking kidding me? How can this man effectively teach a class called "Healthy Nutrition: Eat Your Way to a Beautiful Body" when he is not a model of his teaching? How can anyone take him seriously? Bewildered at the hypocrisy, you leave the class and head to the bursar's office, intent on getting a tuition refund.

When it comes to gurus and financial advisers this is what you must do: leave class and request a refund because they're guilty of a Paradox of Practice.

THE PARADOX OF PRACTICE

The Paradox of Practice asks, "Do you practice what you preach? Are you a model, an exemplification of what you teach?"